

Exercise Session 10: Magnetic Fields in Matter 1

Question 1:

- In atomic terms, explain the origin of paramagnetism and diamagnetism.
- Then compare these with ferromagnetism by discussing why ferromagnetic materials can remain strongly magnetized after an external magnetic field is removed, whereas paramagnetic materials usually do not.
- Finally, explain why diamagnetic and paramagnetic effects are generally much weaker than ferromagnetism.
- Which of the following materials would you expect to be paramagnetic and which diamagnetic: water, magnesium, silver, carbon, sodium, sodium chloride (NaCl), and molecular oxygen (O_2)? Briefly justify your answer in terms of electronic structure.

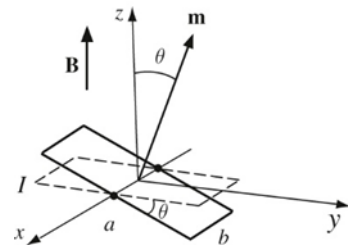
Question 2:

A small rectangular current loop of sides a and b , carrying a steady current I , is placed in a uniform magnetic field

$$\mathbf{B} = B\hat{\mathbf{z}}.$$

The loop is tilted so that its magnetic dipole moment $\mathbf{m}$ makes an angle θ with the $+z$ -axis. Answer the following:

- Why does the loop experience a torque in this uniform magnetic field but no net force?
- What does the torque



$$\mathbf{N} = \mathbf{m} \times \mathbf{B}$$

tend to do to the orientation of the magnetic dipole?

- Even though the forces on opposite sides of the loop cancel in translation, why can they still produce a turning effect?
- Compare this magnetic torque with the torque on an electric dipole in a uniform electric field. What is the key physical similarity, and what is one important physical difference between the two cases?

Question 3:

A piece of magnetic material occupies some finite region of space. There is no free current flowing through the material, but the material is magnetized, so it has a magnetization vector $\mathbf{M}(\mathbf{r})$. The magnetic field of such an object can be described in terms of equivalent bound currents:

$$\mathbf{J}_b = \nabla \times \mathbf{M}, \mathbf{K}_b = \mathbf{M} \times \hat{\mathbf{n}}.$$

Answer the following:

- a) Why can a magnetized object produce a magnetic field even when no free current is flowing through it?
- b) What is the physical meaning of the bound volume current density

$$\mathbf{J}_b = \nabla \times \mathbf{M}?$$

- c) What is the physical meaning of the bound surface current density

$$\mathbf{K}_b = \mathbf{M} \times \hat{\mathbf{n}}?$$

- d) Why can a uniformly magnetized object have zero bound volume current but still have a nonzero bound surface current?
- e) How does nonuniform magnetization inside a material give rise to internal bound currents?

Question 4:

A long hollow cylindrical conductor has inner radius a and outer radius b . It carries a total free current I , uniformly distributed over the conducting cross-section, in the $+z$ -direction. The material is weakly diamagnetic.

- (a) Use Ampere's law for $\mathbf{H}$ to find $\mathbf{H}$ in the regions $s < a$, $a < s < b$, and $s > b$.
- (b) State the direction of $\mathbf{H}$ in each region.
- (c) Briefly explain why magnetization does not change the calculation of $\mathbf{H}$.